30. Bennett, ‘Lloyd George’, pp. 476–8.

31. Morgan, op. cit., p. 147; Bennett, ‘Control’, p. 477; Johnson, op. cit., p. 55; Nicolson, op. cit., p. 34.

32. In 1911, during his time as viceroy, Hardinge had reversed the partition of Bengal, which had been the brainchild of Curzon when he was in India. Curzon apparently never forgave Hardinge. A few years later, in 1917, Curzon had asked Hardinge for his resignation following a critical report on the Mesopotamia Campaign that had occurred under Hardinge’s viceroyalty – ‘I had known Curzon too long to relish having to serve under him at the Foreign Office’. Lord Hardinge of Penhurst, Old Diplomacy , pp. 243–4 and Maisel, op. cit., p. 41.

33. Goldstein, ‘British Peace Aims and the Eastern Question: The Political Intelligence Department and the Eastern Committee, 1918’, Middle Eastern Studies , Vol. 23 (1987), pp. 419–36 (hereafter ‘Peace Aims’).

34. The most common complaint made against Lloyd George is that of his conduct at the Paris Peace Conference and the various other conferences which occurred in the aftermath of the war. As Hardinge observed, the problem with the prime minister was not only his own lack of knowledge but his inability to listen to the advice of experts: ‘If ever he consulted his own Delegation and their advice was not such as he desired, he would take and act upon the opinion of anybody whose views might coincide with his own, whether they really knew anything of the subject or not.’ Hardinge, op. cit., p. 241.

35. McKercher, op. cit., pp. 90–1.

36. In 1922 the GC&CS and Secret Intelligence Service officially came under Foreign Office control: Maisel, op. cit., p. 6.

37. Bennett, ‘Control’, p. 475.

38. Gilmour, Curzon , p. 513; Johnson, op. cit., p. 55.